# YEH JUN LEE

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## EDUCATION

**Ph.D., Marketing** — Pamplin College of Business, Virginia Tech Aug 2021 – 2026
Dissertation defended August 2026. Dissertation: *"The Sensory Connotation of Meaning and the Cues That Fit a Brand"*
Advisor: Prof. Frank May

**M.S., Marketing** — Korea University Business School Mar 2018 – Mar 2020
GPA 4.50 / 4.50 · Academic Excellence Award (highest academic performance in class)
Thesis: *"Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Cars"* (Advisor: Prof. Jongwon Park)

**B.B.A.** — Korea University Business School Mar 2009 – Feb 2016

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Grounded cognition and sensory marketing; cross-modal correspondence and brand meaning; large language models as validated measurement instruments; promotions and product choice; spatial cognition; consumer responses to AI.

**Methods:** experimental design and preregistration; psychometric validation and instrument development; LLM-based measurement; text embeddings and computational text analysis; computer vision features; mixed-effects modeling; field and market-level studies.

## PUBLICATION

Lee, Y. J., & Park, J. (2022). The safety paradox of self-driving cars. *Asia Marketing Journal*, 23(4), 1.

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**"From Brand Meaning to Sensory Design: A Shared Map for Choosing Brand Cues"**
*Sole-authored working paper · targeted to the Journal of Marketing; adding a study that uses sensory vectors for fast, low-cost natural-language product search*

Osgood showed that words carry an affective layer of meaning. This paper asks whether they also carry a sensory one. Drawing on embodied cognition and crossmodal correspondence, it proposes that abstract meanings such as power, intimacy, or renewal occupy reproducible positions in a sensory space, and that a color, a typeface, or a scent can be placed in the same space. The fit between what a brand means and how it looks or smells then becomes something a manager can compare before launch, not something discovered after it. An AI-based instrument recovers these positions from language. Across eight studies and a preregistered replication, they agree with human judgments, explain how similar distant concepts feel beyond semantics and affect, and predict which cues people see as fitting a brand.

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought," *Association for Consumer Research*, Chicago, September 2026.

"SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought," *Society for Consumer Psychology*, San Diego, March 2026.

"The Geometry of Thought," *Association for Consumer Research*, Washington, D.C., October 2025 (Art Festival; interactive system demonstration).

"Spatial Sensitivity: Unveiling Its Effects on Consumer Choice and Perception," *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Sydney, June 2024.

"Exploring the Impact of AI on Creative Processes: The Role of Baseline Creativity and Intrinsic Motivation," *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Miami, June 2023 (with Dipankar Chakravarti).

"Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Vehicles," *American Marketing Association Summer Conference*, August 2020.

## RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

**Multisensory congruence in hotels.** Working paper with Prof. Eojina Kim and Heesun Park. Places the scents and lobby visuals of 86 hotel scent programs (261 images) on shared sensory axes, and asks whether a scent that matches the space raises its appeal or one that counterbalances it works better.

**Spatial sensitivity.** Bounding a scene makes the same movement feel farther (five studies).
**Promotions and usage breadth.** Discounts show larger demand gains for multi-use products (≈3,600 Amazon listings).
**Decision models in marketing.** Cheap AI judgment models for real-time page adaptation (proposal).

## RESEARCH PLATFORMS

**SimSang Brand Fit Index** 2026 – present
Cross-modal fit engine placing meanings and candidate cues on one seven-axis sensory representation. Four cue libraries: fragrance; packaging (1,200 items, pixel-derived computer vision over Amazon Berkeley Objects); wine (194); typeface (659). Bilingual English/Korean. simsang-1efb9.web.app

**SimSang Typeface Finder** 2026 – present
1,569 typefaces ranked against 356 meanings on a shape × weight × feel representation. simsang-type.web.app

**SimSang — perceptual dictionary and scent translator** 2025 – present
Public deployment of the dissertation instrument, mapping abstract concepts to sensory profiles and fragrance space. simsang-202503.onrender.com

**IVDV Explorer** 2024 – present
Literature platform organizing 64,125 variables from 28,570 marketing and psychology papers by construct (IVs, DVs, moderators, mediators). ivdv-cddf3.web.app

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Instructor of Record**, Virginia Tech
- Consumer Behavior (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- Marketing Research (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- International Marketing (undergraduate) — Spring 2023

**Graduate Teaching Assistant**, Korea University Feb 2019 – Mar 2020

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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| ACR Sheth Foundation Scholarship, Association for Consumer Research | 2026 |
| Best Track Award in Consumer Behavior, AMA Summer Conference | 2020 |
| Academic Excellence Award, Korea University Business School | 2019 |
| Research Assistant Scholarship, Korea University Business School | 2019 – 2020 |
| Academic Excellence Scholarship, Korea University Business School | 2018 |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Franklin Templeton Investments** — Marketing Associate Nov 2015 – Dec 2016
Launched two flagship retail funds; developed promotional events and materials; contributed to the Korea-market brand evolution project.

## SKILLS

**Methods & analysis:** R (mixed models), Python (pandas, statsmodels, scikit-learn), experimental design, text embeddings, computer vision features.
**Engineering:** JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Firebase, SurveyJS, Git; LLM APIs (Anthropic, Google, OpenAI).
**Research operations:** Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific, SONA.
**Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent), Chinese (HSK 5).